



GEORGETOWN UNIVERSITY
McCourt School of Public Policy

Request for Proposals Client-Based Capstone Projects 2026-2027

The McCourt School of Public Policy at Georgetown University is seeking proposals for client-based policy analysis research projects to be conducted by graduate student teams, advised by Georgetown University faculty.

About the McCourt School of Public Policy

The McCourt School of Public Policy at Georgetown University is a top-ranked public policy graduate school in the U.S. Our mission is to give our students the rigorous quantitative and analytic skills needed to design and implement smart policies. Our faculty and research centers study policy issues on today's most critical topics including economic security, energy, the environment, education, health, and international development. Our location in Washington, D.C. puts our students at the epicenter of the policy world, allowing them to tap into a rich set of resources outside the classroom as they learn about policy and the policy-making process. Further information about the McCourt School can be found by visiting our website (<http://mccourt.georgetown.edu/>).

Client-Based Policy Analysis Capstone Projects

Students at McCourt School's Master in International Development Policy (MIDP) have the opportunity to complete a client-based policy analysis capstone project as a requirement of their degree. The program emphasizes quantitative and analytical skills for designing and managing sound public policy, within a core curriculum in microeconomics, quantitative methods, and policy process and management. There is a large emphasis on the conduct of impact evaluations, in particular.

Within the structure of a course led by a McCourt faculty member, Jacobus Cilliers, groups of three or four students will work with clients over the Fall 2026 and Spring 2027 semesters to analyze an issue or problem of importance to the client. By early May 2027, students will submit a professional-quality written report analyzing the problem, developing policy alternatives and considering their implications, and making suggestions for implementation of the proposed recommendations. The students will also make an oral presentation of findings to the client. *Please note: this is not an internship.*

Some [examples](#) from previous projects:

- Evaluating the impact of a voucher program for private schools in New Delhi, India
- Use of machine-learning techniques to build a model predicting violence in Iraq.
- Estimating the impacts of Ebola on youth labor market outcomes in Sierra Leone.
- Constructing a novel sub-national panel dataset to analyze the relationship between climate vulnerability and aid distribution.

Request for Proposal

We are reaching out to invite you to propose a project, and ask that you share this invitation with any other colleagues or professional acquaintances whom you believe might be interested in serving as a client. In past years, the McCourt School clients have included government agencies, international organizations, and consulting firms, as well as foundations, non-profits, and other non-government organizations.

To utilize the quantitative and analytical skills that students have been developing in their MIDP degree program, the client-based policy analysis project **must involve, but need not be limited to, analysis of quantitative data**, unless the proposal is to **design** an **evaluation**.

The types of projects we consider include:

1. Regression analysis of randomized control trials.
2. Quasi-experimental analysis.
3. Using machine learning techniques to predict social phenomena of interest.
4. Analysis of survey or administrative data.
5. Support in designing an impact evaluation or developing survey instruments for data collection.

Proposals should be submitted as soon as possible, but no later than **July 10th, 2026**. Please address the proposal to ejc93@georgetown.edu and include the following information:

- **Name of organization and a brief description** of its organization, mission, services, and clients, if appropriate;
- **Organizational contact person** who will serve as the primary point of contact and liaison with the capstone teams throughout the project, and contact information;
- **Brief statement of the purpose of the project** (1-2 paragraphs) and problem to be analyzed by the student team. This section should include the **motivation** underlying the project.
- **Description of existing quantitative data** that the client will provide or that our students will need to access, as well as any restrictions on its use, including the specific datasets to be used
- **Summary of client expectations** for the collaboration with McCourt students.

Selection Criteria

Client projects will be chosen based on how well they meet the McCourt School's requirements for analytical rigor and quantitative analysis within a practical setting, as well as their match with student areas of interest in the topic areas. We are interested in projects that are well-defined in terms of research and policy questions, data requirements and availability as well as desired outputs. Client projects should allow students to provide concrete analysis using quantitative methods, along with meaningful recommendations.

Questions?

Please contact us at ejc93@georgetown.edu if you have any questions or would like to discuss a possible capstone project before submitting a proposal.